

PayPulz, v. Kohl's, Inc.

The initial expert issues are payment-protocol architecture, token or proxy identifiers, authorization-message handling, multi-source allocation and settlement, persistent code-to-authorization mapping, security and non-repudiation, and the allocation of functions among a retailer, client, payment processor, gateway, acquirer, issuer, and any stored-value or wallet provider.

Independent preliminary research based on public information.

FILED	FORUM	DOCKET	MATTER
2026-08-24	U.S. District Court for the Eastern District of Texas, Marshall Division	2:26-cv-00739-JR G	Patent Infringement

Prepared 2026-08-27. No attorney or expert contacted. Availability, interest, compensation, and conflicts not checked.

Public filing, likely recipient, and technical frame

CAPTION	PayPulz, LLC v. Kohl's, Inc.
FORUM / DOCKET	U.S. District Court for the Eastern District of Texas, Marshall Division / 2:26-cv-00739-JRG
FILED / TYPE	2026-08-24 / patent infringement
PUBLIC DOCKET	Open docket

VERIFIED PUBLIC RECORD

The public CourtListener docket and RECAP complaint identify PayPulz, LLC v. Kohl's, Inc., No. 2:26-cv-00739-JRG, filed August 24, 2026 in the Eastern District of Texas. The complaint asserts U.S. Patent No. 12,699,985, titled Proxy Card Management System, and alleges infringement through Kohl's website, mobile applications, and associated shopping and server-side transaction-processing systems. The complaint identifies claim 1 as the sole independent claim and describes a server-side method for an indirect online purchase using a proxy identifier associated with multiple independent monetary accounts.

LIKELY RESEARCH PURCHASER

Oded H. Burger - Partner, Daignault Iyer LLP. Verified docket fact: Burger signs the filed complaint as counsel for PayPulz. The filed complaint publicly lists his exact direct professional email.

oburger@daignaultiyer.com - publicly printed in the [linked professional source](#); not inferred.

TECHNICAL FRAME

The initial expert issues are payment-protocol architecture, token or proxy identifiers, authorization-message handling, multi-source allocation and settlement, persistent code-to-authorization mapping, security and non-repudiation, and the allocation of functions among a retailer, client, payment processor, gateway, acquirer, issuer, and any stored-value or wallet provider.

Secondary-source limitation: The complaint supplies allegations, not proof of the accused implementation. Product architecture, network messages, token-service and payment-processor configurations, source code, contracts, and transactional records must be examined before any technical conclusion. [Open public synopsis](#)

REPORTED ASSERTED PATENTS

[U.S. Patent No. 12,699,985](#)

Questions likely to require expert input

This issue map is a research plan, not a legal conclusion. The filed complaint, patent exhibits, intrinsic record, and discovery must control.

01 Proxy identifier and account association

Does the accused system use a proxy or token identifier that is associated with multiple independent monetary accounts, rather than merely a single payment credential or a merchant account profile?

Potential evidence: Token-service documentation, account and wallet data models, payment-token lifecycle records, API schemas, mobile and web client traces, and server-side identity-resolution code.

02 Rule-based selection and allocation

Does any server retrieve stored user-associated allocation rules and select multiple accounts and respective portions of a purchase amount in the claimed order?

Potential evidence: Rules-engine code, database schemas, configuration records, card-selection and split-tender flows, transaction logs, user-interface captures, and controlled test transactions.

03 Per-account authorization protocol

Are separate payments initiated and authorization information obtained from multiple independent payment systems for one online purchase, and which entity initiates each request?

Potential evidence: Gateway, processor, acquirer, network, and issuer logs; ISO 8583 or API payloads; system sequence diagrams; contracts; and network captures.

04 Proxy authorization code and data mapping

Does a component generate one proxy authorization code from underlying authorization information, retain a code-to-authorization mapping, and return that code in place of the underlying information?

Potential evidence: Authorization-message traces, database tables, token-vault and gateway records, source code, audit logs, reconciliation records, and technical design documents.

Questions likely to require expert input

05 Allocation data and settlement

How are amount allocations communicated to selected accounts and settled to the merchant, and is the alleged functionality a retail checkout feature, a processor feature, or a third-party financial-product feature?

Potential evidence: Settlement files, authorization and capture records, payment-processor APIs, reconciliation data, merchant agreements, test purchases, and operational diagrams.

06 Security, cryptography, and non-repudiation

Do any transaction confirmations use signatures, keys, or other credentials in a manner relevant to the dependent claims, and what data are protected at each boundary?

Potential evidence: Cryptographic specifications, key-management documentation, signed-payload samples, HSM and certificate records, threat models, and security assessments.

07 Attribution among parties and components

Which party or component performs each claimed server-side step: Kohl's applications, its checkout backend, a payment gateway, a wallet provider, an acquirer, card network, issuer, or another service provider?

Potential evidence: Architecture diagrams, cloud and vendor configurations, APIs, source code, contracts, deployment records, data-flow diagrams, and witness testimony.

08 Historical payment-system baseline

What did a person of ordinary skill understand by 2007 regarding tokens, proxy credentials, split tender, multi-account funding, payment authorization, merchant-facing data exposure, and settlement?

Potential evidence: Contemporaneous payment-network specifications, processor manuals, standards, patents, academic literature, public product documentation, and a supported POSITA analysis.

Candidates 1-2 for further diligence

Ranked for preliminary research priority based on subject-matter fit, relevant public work, testimony, and visible diligence burden. This is not a retention recommendation.

01 Ari Juels, PhD

Weill Family Foundation and Joan and Sanford I. Weill Professor of Computer Science, Cornell Tech; co-director, Initiative for CryptoCurrencies and Contracts; Chief Scientist, Chainlink Labs

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for cryptographic financial systems, authentication, privacy, digital assets, and the design and security implications of server-mediated financial protocols.

RELEVANT WORK

Cornell identifies Juels as a professor and IC3 co-director, with research interests including blockchains, cryptocurrency, smart contracts, applied cryptography, user authentication, and privacy; it also records prior leadership at RSA Laboratories and EMC.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No public testifying role was located in this preliminary bounded search; this is not a representation that none exists.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

His work is strong on financial cryptography and protocols, but a matter-specific review is needed for conventional card-network implementation and for any Chainlink or financial-sector relationships.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | juels@cornell.edu | [public email source](#)

02 Matthew D. Green, PhD

Associate Professor of Computer Science, Johns Hopkins University

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for applied cryptography, cryptographic engineering, anonymous-payment systems, key management, and the security properties of proxy and authorization data.

RELEVANT WORK

Johns Hopkins describes Green's research as applied cryptography and cryptographic engineering, including privacy-enhanced information storage and anonymous payment systems; it identifies him as a creator of the Zerocash protocol.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No clear public testifying role was located in this preliminary bounded search; this is not a representation that none exists.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The core infringement questions may turn more on legacy payment-message flows and retailer/vendor architecture than on advanced cryptography; prior consulting and financial-technology relationships require diligence.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | mgreen@cs.jhu.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 3-4 for further diligence

03 Dan Boneh, PhD

Professor of Computer Science and Electrical Engineering; co-director, Stanford Computer Security Lab, Stanford University

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for applied cryptography, authorization credentials, digital signatures, protocol security, and secure systems handling sensitive payment data.

RELEVANT WORK

Boneh's Stanford page identifies his research focus as applied cryptography and computer security and lists coursework in cryptocurrencies and blockchain technologies alongside cryptography.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No clear public testifying role was located in this preliminary bounded search; this is not a representation that none exists.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

A very senior academic profile may be less focused on the operational allocation and settlement mechanics of a retail checkout stack; institutional, industry, and prior-opinion diligence is necessary.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | dabo@cs.stanford.edu | [public email source](#)

04 Gene Tsudik, PhD

Distinguished Professor of Computer Science and NetSys Co-Director, University of California, Irvine

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for applied cryptography, authentication, digital signatures, security protocol analysis, and privacy at the boundaries between payment-system components.

RELEVANT WORK

UCI identifies Tsudik as a Distinguished Professor and describes research interests in security, privacy, and applied cryptography; the university also records his prior IBM Zurich and USC/ISI work.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No clear public testifying role was located in this preliminary bounded search; this is not a representation that none exists.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

His public profile is broad security and cryptography rather than merchant-acquirer payment operations; a separate payments-systems practitioner may be needed for transaction-flow evidence.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | gts@ics.uci.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 5-6 for further diligence

05 Nitesh Saxena, PhD

Professor of Computer Science and MS Cyber Security Program Co-Director, University of Alabama at Birmingham

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for applied cryptography, authentication, mobile security, and payment-adjacent user and device security questions arising from web and mobile-app checkout flows.

RELEVANT WORK

UAB lists Saxena as a Professor of Computer Science and MS Cyber Security Program Co-Director. Its public CyberCorps materials identify him as principal investigator and program director and publicly list his direct email.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No clear public testifying role was located in this preliminary bounded search; this is not a representation that none exists.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The match is strongest on mobile, authentication, and security rather than multi-account allocation and settlement; current external relationships and prior opinions should be checked.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | saxena@uab.edu | [public email source](#)

06 Patrick Traynor, PhD

Professor and John and Mary Lou Dasburg Preeminent Chair in Engineering, University of Florida

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for mobile-system and network security, payment-adjacent mobile-device communications, applied cryptography, and evaluation of security boundaries in a transaction architecture.

RELEVANT WORK

The University of Florida describes Traynor's work as mobile-system, telecommunications-infrastructure, Internet-security, and applied-cryptography research; it identifies him as SENSEI Lab co-director and Pindrop Security co-founder.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No clear public testifying role was located in this preliminary bounded search; this is not a representation that none exists.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The public profile emphasizes telecom and mobile security; whether the engagement needs merchant-payment protocol expertise rather than mobile-channel expertise must be determined from discovery.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | traynor@cise.ufl.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 7-8 for further diligence

07 David Wagner, PhD

Carl J. Penther Chair in Engineering and Professor, Computer Science Division, University of California, Berkeley

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for computer security, applied cryptography, secure system implementation, auditing, and technical analysis of sensitive authorization data and payment-adjacent protocols.

RELEVANT WORK

Wagner's Berkeley profile identifies research in computer security and applied cryptography, including secure-computing centers and projects. His public cryptography materials address implementation attacks and security of cryptographic systems in practice.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Public materials show election-system review work, but no clear litigation-testifying role was located in this preliminary bounded search; this is not a representation that none exists.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The profile does not establish expertise in a particular retail-payment vendor stack. Any prior security-review engagements, industry ties, or opinions require targeted diligence.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | daw@cs.berkeley.edu | [public email source](#)

08 Susan Landau, PhD

Professor of Cyber Security and Policy and Director, Cybersecurity Center, Tufts University

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for security and privacy architecture, exposure of sensitive transaction data, cryptographic controls, and explaining technical security consequences to legal factfinders.

RELEVANT WORK

Tufts identifies Landau as a cybersecurity-and-policy professor and Cybersecurity Center director. Her profile records work in cybersecurity, privacy, and communications surveillance, prior roles at Google and Sun Microsystems, and congressional testimony on related technical-policy questions.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

Tufts records congressional testimony and policy briefings; no clear litigation-testifying role was located in this preliminary bounded search.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The connection is strongest for data-security and privacy questions, not necessarily for the transaction-allocation mechanics at the heart of claim 1; the litigation role and technical scope would need careful alignment.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | susan.landau@tufts.edu | [public email source](#)

Candidates 9-10 for further diligence

09 Nicolas Christin, PhD

Professor, Engineering and Public Policy and Software and Societal Systems Department, Carnegie Mellon University

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for applied systems security, security analytics, economic transactions, cybercrime, and assessment of security and operational behavior in complex transaction networks.

RELEVANT WORK

Carnegie Mellon identifies Christin as a professor with work at the systems, networking, and policy boundary. His public materials describe empirical study informed by users, networks, and economic transactions and identify security analytics as a useful description of his work.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No clear public testifying role was located in this preliminary bounded search; this is not a representation that none exists.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

His broader systems-and-policy orientation may be less direct than a payment-network engineer's knowledge of authorization and settlement message flows; scope and possible relationships need diligence.

[Source 1](#) | [Source 2](#)

[Draft email](#) | nicolasc@cmu.edu | [public email source](#)

10 Tadayoshi Kohno, PhD

Professor and McDevitt Chair in Computer Science, Ethics, and Society, Georgetown University

TECHNICAL FIT

Strong fit for applied cryptography, security and privacy design, threat modeling, and explaining whether an authentication or authorization architecture reduces exposure of sensitive information across a distributed system.

RELEVANT WORK

Kohno's public page identifies his current Georgetown role, former UW security-and-privacy research leadership, and co-authorship of Cryptography Engineering: Design Principles and Practical Applications.

PUBLIC LITIGATION EXPERIENCE

No clear public testifying role was located in this preliminary bounded search; this is not a representation that none exists.

POINTS FOR FURTHER DILIGENCE

The public page emphasizes security research and ethics rather than legacy retail payment operations; any role should be tightly scoped to security architecture and reviewed for current external commitments.

[Source 1](#)

[Draft email](#) | yoshi.kohno@georgetown.edu | [public email source](#)

Preliminary candidates; no conflicts or availability determination

- Run party, affiliate, counsel, inventor, funder, and technology conflicts.
- Confirm testimony history, exclusions, compensation, publications, patents, and deposition performance.
- Investigate licensing, grants, consulting, commercial interests, and prior technical positions.
- Confirm role fit, availability, and interest only after counsel authorizes outreach.

ONGOING MATTER-SPECIFIC RESEARCH

Flint Witness Research works in the post-filing window, turning pleadings and public technical records into issue maps, researched candidate slates, and diligence starting points as the case develops.

[Schedule a 15-minute conversation](#)

CORE SOURCES

Public docket: <https://www.courtlistener.com/docket/74665720/paypulz-llc-v-kohls-inc/>

Public professional email source: <https://storage.courtlistener.com/recap/gov.uscourts.txed.248639/gov.uscourts.txed.248639.1.0.pdf>

Public technical context source: <https://storage.courtlistener.com/recap/gov.uscourts.txed.248639/gov.uscourts.txed.248639.1.0.pdf>

LIMITATIONS

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